MOC B-Hynd Rogaine, Saturday 28th May 2005

Planners Comments.

Firstly, thanks to the Landowners who gave us permission to use their properties.

Rick and Mark Osborne	'Redwood'
Jim Butt	'Musgrave Downs'
Chris Bowron	'Malvern Hills'

Without the willing consent of these guys the event would not have happened. By the look of it we left the course unscathed apart from a few footprints, so well done everyone. It certainly helps getting access to other properties when we can refer landowners to previous event hosts who have had a positive experience.

Next, thanks to our longsuffering families, who in my case endured my going from seven days a week working through vintage, to disappearing for much of three consecutive weekends. I'm still sitting on negative brownie points.

It has been a lot of fun planning this event, and I guess we learned a great deal about what is involved. Jut and I took on the job because we like the concept of Rogaines, where the emphasis is on route choice and knowing your own capabilities, rather than absolute accuracy on a detailed map.

There are a few things that stick in my mind that may be of use to future Rogaine planners.

Site selection.
The ideal site is one that is close to town, but offers a variety of terrain, with sufficient topographical features to enable controls to be set on the limited detail on a Topo map. In reality the sites that are available that fit this description have been used already in previous rogaines, so to get into new territory we had to look further afield. The up side is that you get to experience country you may otherwise never visit.

Landowners.
Having settled on a general locality, we needed to get permission to use adjoining land to give sufficient variety to the course. We were denied permission to use part of the Summerlands property, which would have enabled us to provide a better balance of rolling vs steep country, and move away from the heavily forested areas. There were also a few limitations on the properties we were allowed onto, but these were minor.

Course planning.
In retrospect we could have done with another site visit prior to setting control positions. We selected likely control positions based on geographical features on the map, but when we came to setting out controls found we had to change or delete some, as they were impractical given the vegetation cover.

Setting out Controls.
We allowed two days to set these out, but one day was so cloudy we could only see 150m. Consequently we were so slow finding control positions that we got caught in the dark, and had to come back the day before the event to complete the last few, knowing that the map was at the printers, and we had no way of changing any if we needed to!

Weather & Competitor safety.
Having experienced the limitations of being caught in cloud made us aware that Planners need to have a 'B' plan if the weather is foul. Fortunately we had a fine break in the otherwise poor spell of weather, and competitors were able to enjoy the views after all the hard climbing.

Communications
We are very grateful to Mondo for his considerable effort in publicity and coordinating entries etc, and to Lisa for the hours spent checking control cards and confirming results after the event. It is critical that the planners have this sort of back up so that they can concentrate on the map, rather than the event logistics.

Summary
Jut and I have discussed at length where we could have improved the course, as the participants have no doubt re-evaluated their route choices. We would like to plan another event, and have a site in mind, but I don't think it will be next year!

If you are minded to have a go at setting any event, allow plenty of time to view & plan, so you don't get pressured at the eleventh hour, and you will find it a very rewarding experience. We had a lot of positive feedback from competitors, and just seeing everyone out there makes it all worthwhile.

Cheers
Jut & Lachy

A few words from Mondo – MOC Club Secretary

On behalf of both the club and the competitors I wish to convey our appreciation and thanks to Lachy and Jut for all their efforts in planning this event and setting out such a great course in a beautiful location.

While I was out competing and then when collecting up controls the next day I marvelled at how much work they must have put in visiting potential control sites, linking up route options between controls, confirming and checking control sites, putting them out etc. I really appreciated being able to just turn up on the day and compete.

Those that climbed high were rewarded with some glorious views over the surrounding landscape. A number of controls had 'treats' (lollies) at them and this was a nice touch.

Thanks to various club members who helped out on the day with the BBQ, entries, finishers etc. It was good to see lots of you out competing as well and enjoying yourselves.

Cheers to Greg Hall from Adventure Sportsworld for the spot prizes. We didn't expect to have any prizes but Greg kindly offered these and we are grateful for his generosity. This was also Greg's first rogaine and I know that he was buzzing out on his experience and rumour has it he may have a crack at the NZ 24Hr Champs in 2006.

BIG thanks to all competitors for your participation. From the various post event chatter I gather that you all enjoyed yourselves and are keen to have a go at more rogaines – excellent!!! Isn't it such a GREAT sport? Planning, strategy, team work, fitness, navigation, cunning, seeing no-one at times then seeing lots of people, decisions – shall I go this way or that way, should I duck up the hill and grab those extra points, time to head home, arrrgghhhhh I'm going to be late, just made it in time, where did you go, how many points etc etc. And all with the basic of gear.

Finally just to reiterate some words that Lachy and Jut touched on, we are extremely grateful to the landowners for allowing us access to their properties which means we can have an event. Both the clubs proactive communication and competitors' behaviour on the day goes a long way to leaving a positive and lasting impression with the landowners which in turn can benefit assists us when approaching other landowners for future events.

Thanks to you all for keeping this in mind.

See you all in 2006.